User research → scoped product requirements | Aug–Sep 2026

NetEase Cloud Music

A mobile-product study connecting survey evidence, public feedback, QQ Music and Spotify comparisons to three proposals for music discovery, uninterrupted listening, and report-status transparency.

159	110	30	12
responses collected	retained responses	public feedback items	requirement groups

My work

Survey design and synthesis, issue classification and association analysis, requirement scoring, competitive comparison, and a three-feature PRD.

Delivery status

Research and requirements are complete. Screens are conceptual wireframes. Current-version checks, technical review, usability validation and rollout remain future work; metrics describe a validation plan.

Sample boundaries

19 survey questions. Ages 18–30: 101 (91.8%); students: 83 (75.5%); men: 79. Recruitment used personal networks and forwarding. Findings describe this sample.

How evidence is used

Survey results estimate reach and segment differences. Thirty public feedback items provide task-level context. Associations inform hypotheses with explicit limits on causal interpretation.

Findings from the 110 retained responses

Separate friction from behavioral consequences

Evidence	Sample finding	Product implication
Search usage	109 of 110 respondents	Protect the path from discovery to playback
Promotion friction	51 (46.4%); 2.50 / 5 rating	Unify timing, frequency, dismissal and task recovery
Navigation friction	37 (33.6%); usability 2.95 / 5	Prioritize stable core entry points and configurable modules
Catalog problems	25; 23 reported behavior/payment changes	Distinguish licensing dependencies from interface scope
Lapsed membership	30 of 32 used competing apps	Evaluate renewal value as a separate segment
Repeated recommendations	24 of 64 recommendation users	Preserve matching strengths; improve exploration and control

Analysis method

3,000 permutation tests for associations; Cramer's V for categorical relationships and epsilon-squared for score/intention differences. Benjamini–Hochberg FDR correction covered 34 tests.

Interpretation limits

Advertising was frequent and poorly rated, but its association with reported behavioral change did not remain significant after FDR adjustment. Repetition complaints came from active recommendation users; exposure affects the pattern.

Preserve existing strengths

Positive feedback highlighted preference matching, synchronized lyrics, stable playback, and comment stories. Proposed improvements target specific gaps within user tasks.

Keep the original scoring record and final PRD scope distinct

From 12 requirement groups to three proposals

Final proposal	Requirement lineage	Scope decision
Complete artist catalog browsing	R07	P1; accessible entries, filters, sort order and explicit batch scope
Promotion control and module management	R02 / R03	P1; current-version and membership checks precede development
Report progress and interaction safety	R09 / R10	P0; prioritize a traceable safety and trust workflow

Prioritization framework

Reach, task impact, behavioral impact and evidence strength each receive 1–3 points. Core-task blockers and safety issues qualify for P0. R01 has A/B subrequirements: 12 groups and 13 scored entries.

Scope revision

Early drafts explored licensing explanations, cloud-library batch tools and cross-device synchronization. Rechecking existing capabilities and concrete feedback removed complex mechanisms with weak evidence or heavy dependencies from the final scope. Original scores remain decision history.

Competitive lenses

QQ Music is the domestic direct competitor for retrieval, content and memberships. Spotify is the product-model reference for library organization, recommendation control and cross-device tasks. Observations retain the August 20, 2026 research cutoff.

Turn comparisons into decisions

Evaluate whether users can identify operation scope, resume listening, and track report handling. List licensing supply, synchronization and commercial revenue as dependencies with validation gates.

Find the catalog. Confirm the operation scope.

Main path

Artist page → all songs/albums → filter by type and release date → play current results or add them to a playlist → review outcome details.

Business rules

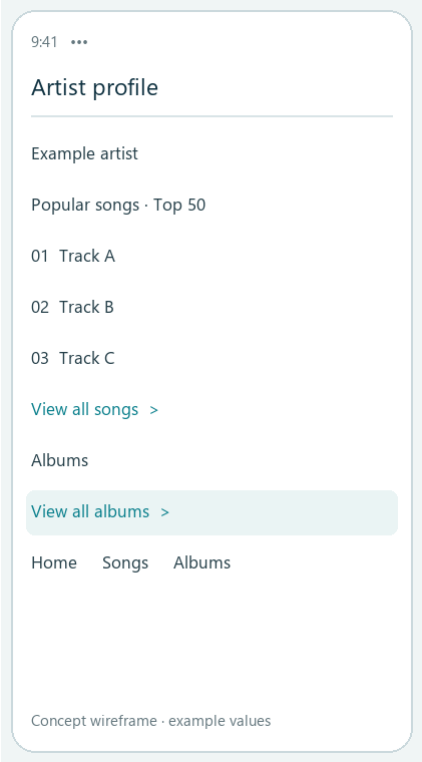
Label the popular section “Top 50” and expose the complete catalog. Unknown metadata goes to “Other.” Deduplicate batch additions and report added, existing, unavailable and failed items separately.

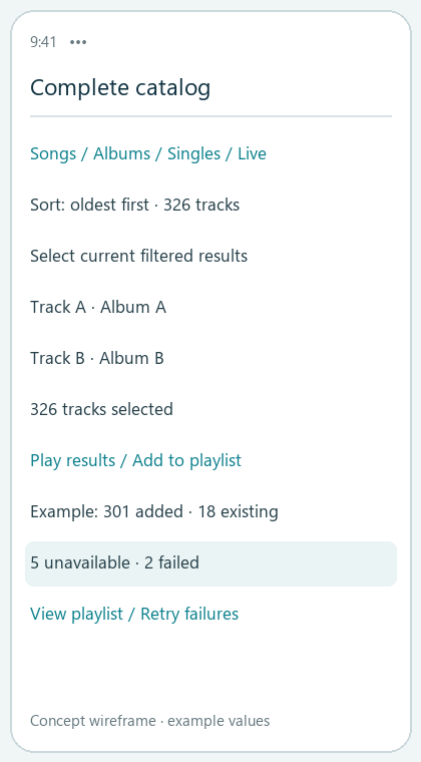
Recovery behavior

Pagination and background tasks keep large catalogs usable. Preserve filters and scroll position when returning. Retry failed items only, using idempotency to avoid duplicate successful writes.

Acceptance and measures

Check entry visibility, filtering, playback scope and batch outcomes. Track full-catalog entry reach, task completion, batch success and failed-item recovery.





P1 | Current-release checks are a prerequisite

Dismiss the promotion. Resume the task.

Display decision

Check task context, playback, session/day limits, recent dismissal, membership entitlement and creative validity. Defer ordinary promotions or use a non-blocking area when interruption is inappropriate.

Dismissal and frequency

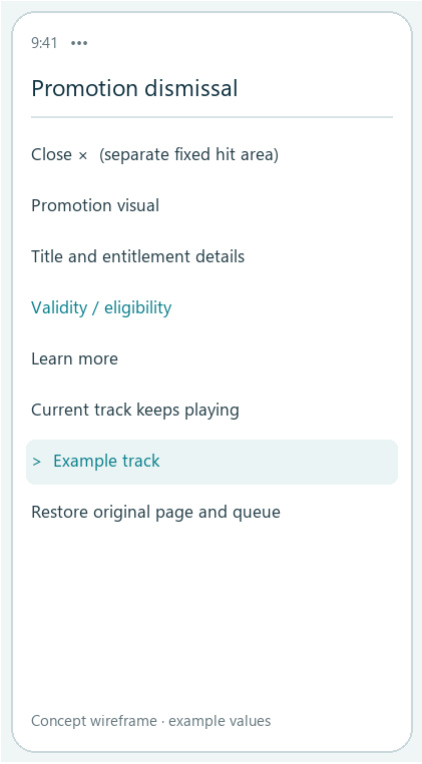
After dismissal, the same promotion stays suppressed for the session. A session ends after more than 30 minutes in the background. Separate dismissal from navigation; the PRD specifies a fixed hit area of at least 44 × 44 pt.

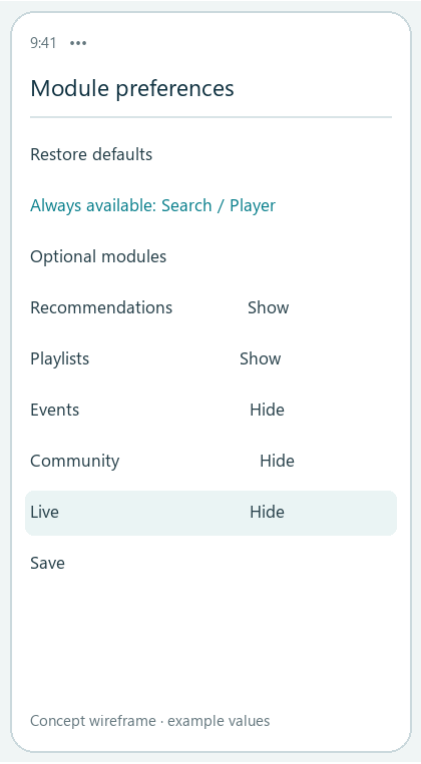
Modules and entitlements

Keep search, playback, safety and account entries accessible. Optional modules can be hidden, reordered and reset. Entitlement failures use a low-interruption fallback; safety notices use separate rules.

Validation and measures

Retest signed-out, free, VIP and SVIP accounts across launch/return/track-change scenarios and network conditions. Compare repeat exposure, task recovery, accidental navigation and commercial conversion together.





Make report handling visible and traceable.

Routing and state

Violations go to reporting; unrelated content goes to quality feedback; personal dislikes go to preference controls. Show “Accepted” only after the server returns a case ID, followed by review, additional-information requests and an outcome.

Immediate protection

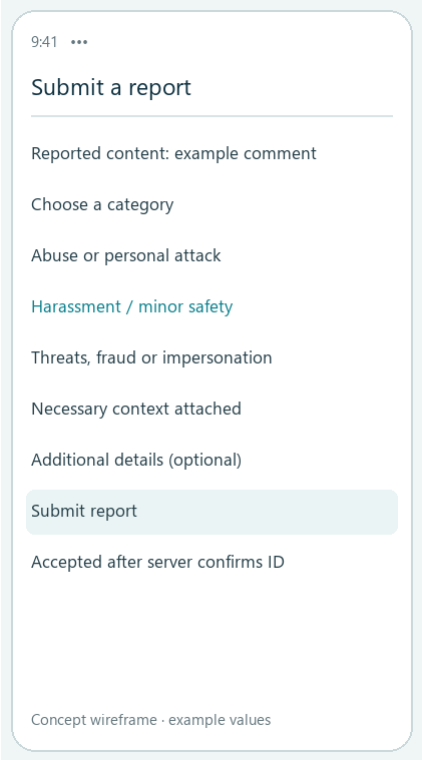
Exit and local blocking take effect first. During network failure, isolate locally and sync later. Blocking is personal contact control. Moderation uses evidence and rules; report volume supports triage.

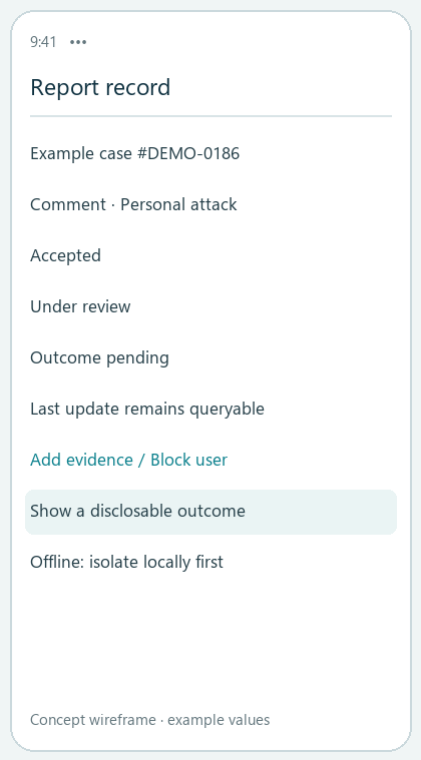
Privacy and failures

Keep unsuccessful submissions as drafts. Repeated submissions open the existing case with an option to add evidence. Disclose necessary outcome categories; the record center remains available when notifications fail.

Acceptance and measures

Check IDs, consistent states, evidence supplementation, queryable outcomes and offline isolation. Measure acceptance success/latency, handling time, outcome visibility and post-block contact failures.





Define reviewable next steps

Validation plan and delivery evidence

Stage	Checks	Decision gate
Baseline	Current-release verification and 14-day measures	Remove resolved or unreproducible issues
Limited rollout	Release in stages with rollback switches	Evaluate task experience, performance, revenue and safety
Evaluation	Success rates, failures, handling times and guardrails	Set targets from baseline; pause expansion on serious failures

Artifacts

Research synthesis; needs analysis and priority matrix; QQ Music/Spotify comparison; full Chinese PRD; bilingual case studies and six concept wireframes with task flows and business rules.

Traceability

Scenario → flow → prototype → event → acceptance criterion. Section 16 of the full PRD contains the mapping; this case explains the three task chains separately.

Implementation dependencies

Content metadata and playlist services, client/ad SDK behavior, membership entitlements, moderation-state APIs, customer operations and analytics. Each dependency has a failure-handling rule.

Project context

An independent product-research project studying the NetEase Cloud Music mobile app. Deliverables include user research, prioritization, competitive analysis, product requirements and concept wireframes.

Project repository

https://github.com/Ginga2003/netease-cloud-music-product-case